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Chapter 1

Introduction and getting started

1.1 Introduction Part 1: Workflow - Session view + arrangement view

- When you open Ableton the software there will be a little box in the lower left corner of the screen. When you hover your mouse at any button, text will appear in this lower left corner box, describing what the button does.

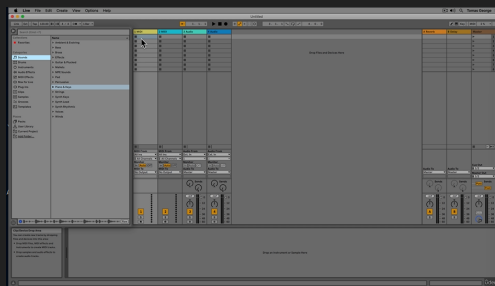
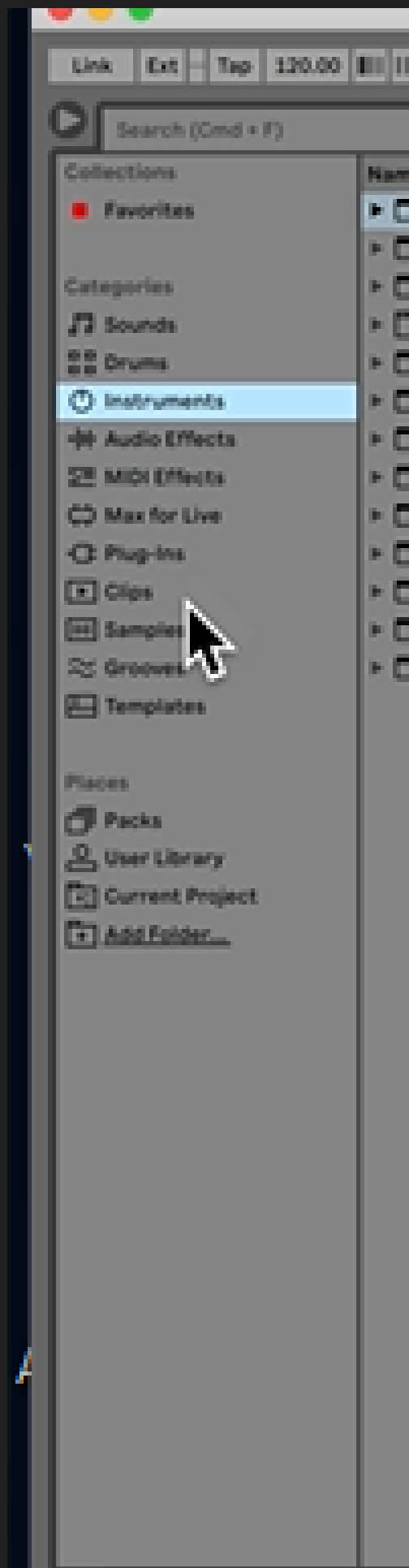


Figure 1.1:

- On the top left we see the browser:



[H]

- The browser displays to you all the options you have, there is where you will find all the clips and tracks ready to go just to drag and drop.
- There are two main views: session view and arrangement view. You can switch between them using the tab key.

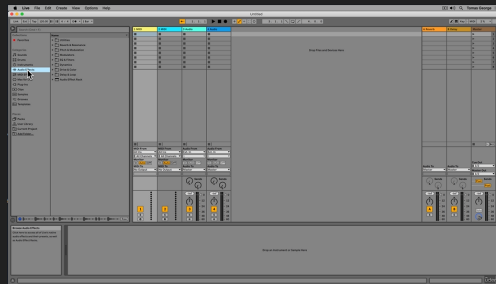


Figure 1.3: Session view

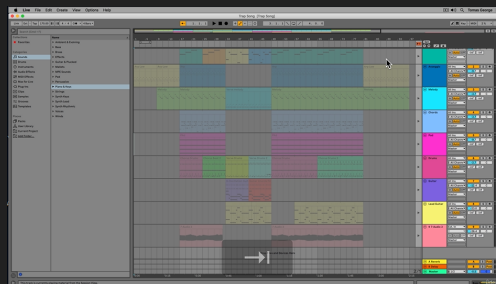


Figure 1.4: Arrangement view

- Across the session view each of the columns are a separate track:



Figure 1.5: Tracks

- We can have midi and audio tracks.
- Each of the squares in the following picture in the tracks is used to insert clips:



Figure 1.6: Adding clips

- If you play the right most triangle then all the clips and midis in that row will play. This is known as a scene.



Figure 1.7: Scenes

- You can stop all clips with the 'stop all clips' button in the right middle part:



Figure 1.8: Stop all clips

- In the session view all of the tracks are listed vertically.

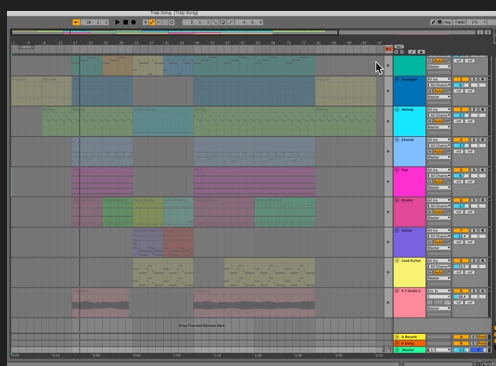


Figure 1.9: Session view's tracks

- You can play and stop the tracks by pressing the space bar or pressing in the stop tracks button, which in session view looks like this:

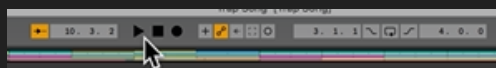


Figure 1.10: Stop all tracks

- You can move the cursor to any point of the song by simply selecting it and moving it left or right.

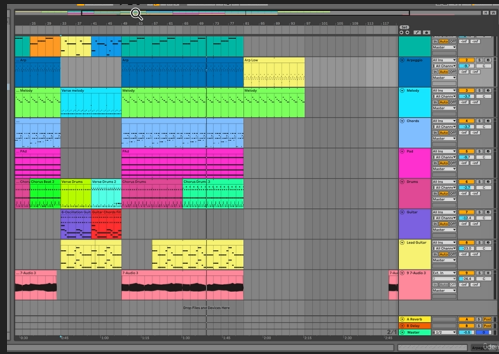


Figure 1.11:

- The difference between session view and arrangement view is that the session view holds your musical ideas, and the arrangement view is used to structure your different ideas into a song.
- So the recommendation is to **come up with all of your musical ideas in the session view and structure them in the arrangement view**. This is not necessary, but it is recommended.

1.2 Introduction - Part 2: Creating clips

- Creating a clip can be as easy or as difficult as you require. You can pick an already made clip from the browser, or record your own clip and import it to Ableton.
- Once you select a clip or sample you can simply click it and drag and drop it to a slot in the session view.

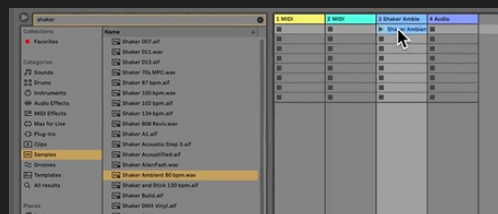


Figure 1.12: Clips drag and drop

- By selecting the clip already in the clip slot we can see the waveform of the clip.



Figure 1.13: Waveform of the clip

- Now let's open the MIDI column and insert a MIDI track, once we click on an empty slot in the MIDI track we see that the following is displayed:

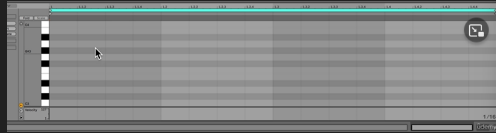


Figure 1.14: Midi

- We can select which notes we want and create chords to our own song.

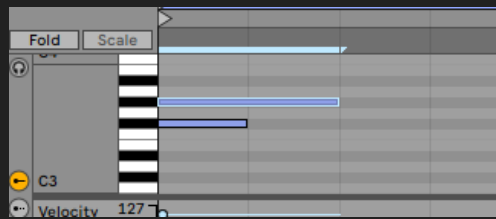


Figure 1.15: Midi note editor

- You can adjust the note length by pressing the note:

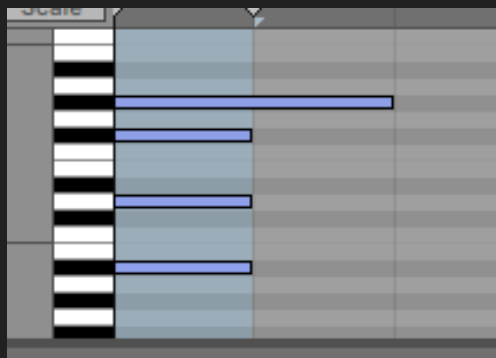


Figure 1.16: Note length

- Notice that if you play it it does not actually make any sound. This is because midi tracks need an instrument to create sound. We must load an instrument.
 - Just go to the 'instruments' tab in your browser and select one.
 - Drag and drop it in the midi.

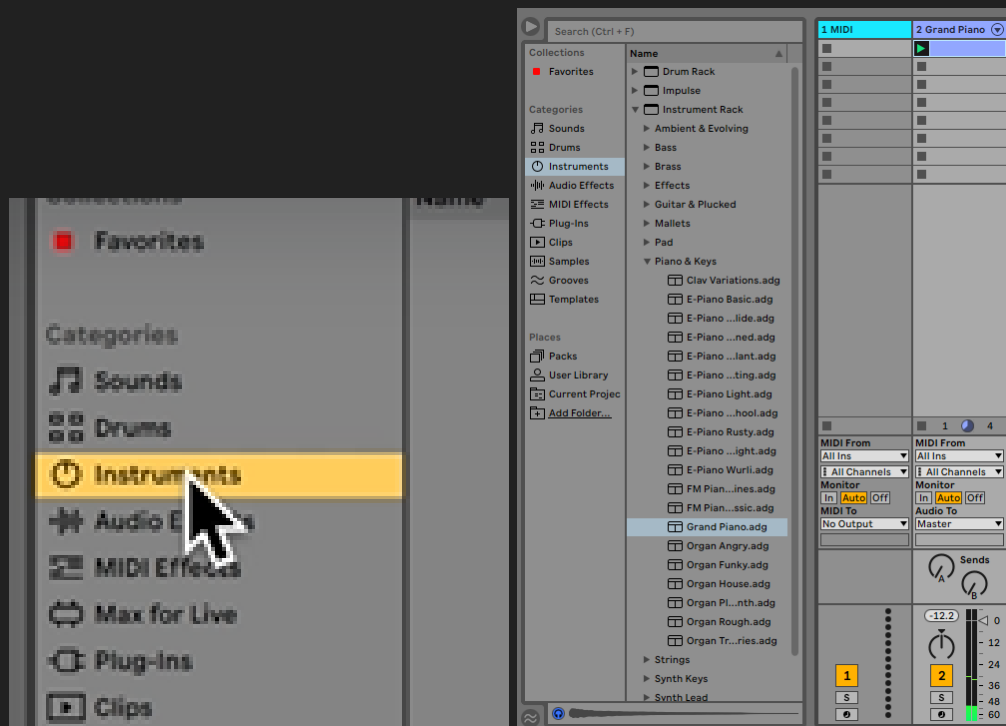


Figure 1.17: Adding an instrument to the midi track

- Notice that the audio clips do not need an instrument to sound, this is because they are just audio. Whereas midi is more like instructions that need to be executed using an instrument.
- We can use all the available slots in the midi and clip columns to add as many sounds as you like.
- Now we record the clips to arrange them the arrangement view. Do this by pressing the red button and playing the tracks when you want them.



Figure 1.18: Recording

- To tell ableton that we are done recording and we are now going to be arranging we press the following button:

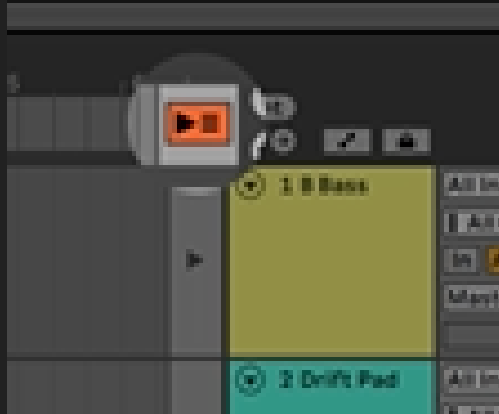


Figure 1.19: Back to arrangement button

- Now we see our samples in the arrangement view:



Figure 1.20: Arrangement view

1.3 Introduction - Part 3: Basic Track Controls

- Once in arrangement view, if you ever need to listen to just one track and silence all the other ones there is a button for that called the solo track. It looks like this:



Figure 1.21: Solo track button

- You can adjust the volume of a track by dragging the slider left or right:



Figure 1.22: Adjusting track volume

- We can adjust the panning of a track to adjust how far left or right it appears in the stereo image. Basically when you have 2 channels of sound sometimes you want sound to sound only in one channel rather than on 2. When you have earphones this is common, one sound only shows up in one side and not in both. This is to create an effect.



Figure 1.23: Panning

- By double-clicking you restore the panning and the volume to default.

- By clicking on the orange track number shown below, we can mute that track:



Figure 1.24: Muting one track

- You can also access all of these controls in the session view. Here they are visually different but do the same things. Whatever you do in the session view will take effect in the arrangement view and vice-versa.



Figure 1.25: Session view controls

Chapter 2

Before we get started - Ableton Live Information

2.1 Ableton Live Editions

- There are different editions of ableton.
- This course is for live suite ableton 11 users.
- You can check out what features are included with your version here: <https://www.ableton.com/en/live/compare-editions/>

2.2 Ableton Live Packs

- You can see the packs available with your version of ableton 11.
- You can see which packs come with you version here:

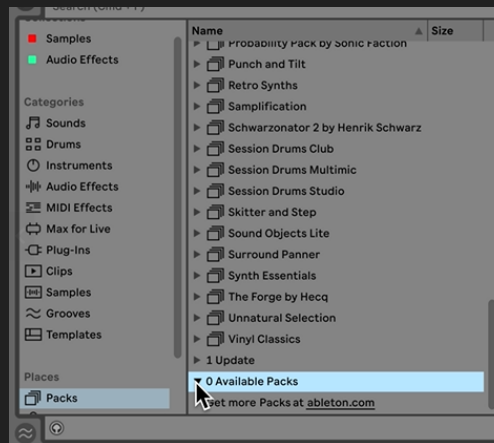


Figure 2.1:

- Also you can checkout paid and free packs by clicking in the "Get more packs at ableton.com".

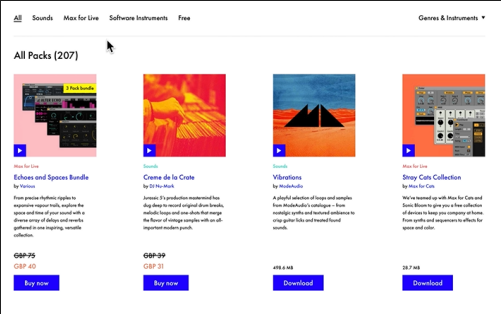


Figure 2.2: Ableton packs.

Chapter 3

In-Depth overview of Ableton Live nad Making a Song

3.1 Setting The Tempo Of The Project

- First create a set by going to File > New Live Set.
- The tempo is the speed or the beats per minute, depending on the song you are composing the tempo will be different.

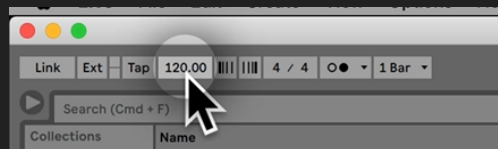


Figure 3.1: Tempo

- By pressing the space bar you can hear the metronome at the beats per minute specified.



Figure 3.2: Metronome

- The tap button can be used to adjust the beats per minute of your project. Every time you tap, ableton will adjust the beats per minute.



Figure 3.3: Tap button

3.2 Audio tracks

- In session view we had the columns the capacity to hold you midi and audio tracks. We already saw sort of what is midi, the audio tracks we left pending.

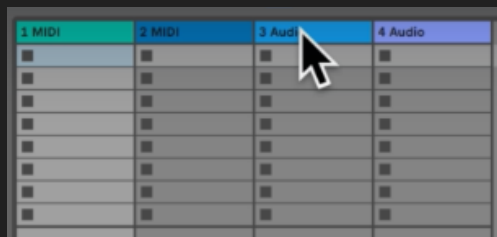


Figure 3.4:

- Audio tracks hold audio files, these can be prerecorded sounds, or tracks, or even recordings.
- With audio tracks you don't need to load an instrument.
- You can add an audio track by selecting a track from the samples tab in Categories.
- Once you choose the track you like you can just drag and drop it to an audio slot. If you double click the track it will open the sample display in the clip view which will represent the wave form graph.

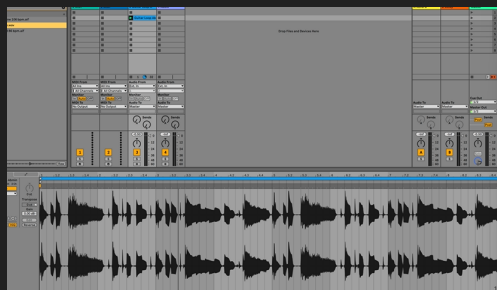


Figure 3.5: